

hanging for many minor offenses was abolished, education was fostered and encouraged thruout the land for all classes. An era of security and stability prevailed and did much to establish and strengthen the monarch in the people's esteem and confidence. By the end of this time a great deal had been done to transform a loose bunch of provinces into a real Kingdom.

D.FROM DAVID I TO WILLIAM WALLACE.After David I came his grandson, Malcolm IV, the Maiden,(1153-1165) who was a strong ruler although he was soft and girlish looking(hence the Maiden). But he died at age 24 with no children and was followed by his brother William who ruled from 1165 to 1214. He was called "the Lion" since he put the lion in place of the dragon in the royal arms of Scotland. He was the 1st Scottish King to enter into an alliance with France against England. This connection brought evil as well as good to Scotland over the long run.

In attempting to regain lands from England, William was captured and imprisoned in Normandy. He obtained freedom by giving up certain Scotch castles, and by acknowledging the English King as overlord of all Scotland in both Church and State. "The Independence of Scotland was laid away for the liberty of one man." In 1189, King Richard Coeur de Lion of England, being pressed for money, restored the castles and independence of Scotland for 10,000 marks of silver. After ruling 49 years, William the Lion had the distinction of dying in his own bed of natural causes.

Alexander II(1214-1249), son of William, was only 16 when he came to the throne. For 35 years he was a sensible, useful, and judicious King; his reign was one of prosperity, progress, good laws, justice and improvement of agriculture. During his time, the prestige and authority of royalty was greatly enhanced.

Alexander was also interested in foreign affairs. He aided English Barons when they forced their King John to sign the Magna Carta, a great victory for democracy. In 1215 and 1217 Alexander invaded England and after making peace married Johanna, sister of Henry III who as a child succeeded his father, King John.

Most significant in Alexander's reign was the expedition he organized in 1249 to rescue the Western Isles from the Norsemen. In this he was supported by Cormac Mhor(the Great), Chief of the MacQuarries of Ulva.(More of this later.) Alexander II died in 1249 and was followed by his son Alexander III. Though only 8 when crowned, he ruled from 1249-1286 as a strong, effective king. He married his cousin, Margaret, daughter of Henry III of England. Thus his uncle became his father-in-law, but Alexander refused to be a vassal to Henry and remained very independent.

Most notable during his reign was the victory over the Norwegians at Largs in 1263. For over 2 centuries, the Western Isles had been held by Norsemen who owed nominal feudal loyalty to the King of Norway. When Alexander III tried to break this tie, King Haakon of Norway sent a fleet of 160 ships, loaded with warriors, into the Firth of Clyde. Haakon delayed attacking and a violent storm came up. Some of the Norse warriors were landed, but many were blown out to sea. Alexander took advantage of the confusion, attacked on land and routed the smaller force. The remaining Norse ships sailed back to Norway with Haakon dying on